years by the Security Forces (SF). Until the Oting incident, the SF had not provided any trigger for the local Naga sentiments to turn antagonistic towards the SF.

Earlier, in end-November, joint operations between the Army and AR had been carried out in the same area, based on credible intelligence corroborated at the Multi-Agency Centre (MAC) level, a forum for intelligence sharing, of terrorists of a proscribed group. However, nothing came out of it, and the operations were called off late on 2 December 2021. The very next day, based on specific inputs from sources of 21 PARA (SF), the operations were launched again into the same general area, but this time they went by themselves. As reported by 21 PARA (SF), contact with suspected insurgents was made between 1600 and 1700 hours on 4 December 2021, who were moving in a pick-up type of truck from Tiru to Oting, by which time it was already dusk. Initial reports revealed six fatal and two non-fatal civilian casualties. After hearing the firing, a mob congregated and attacked the 21 PARA (SF) team, who in self-defence were forced to fire back on the violent mob and managed to extricate themselves to safety. The scuffle resulted in seven more civilian casualties and severe injury to three soldiers of the 21 PARA (SF) team, out of which one soldier later succumbed to his injuries. The next day, on 5 December, the local public gathered in Mon Town for the funeral of the deceased civilians. However, information that the funeral had been rescheduled for the next day was, or could not be communicated to all, which infuriated the gathering that soon turned into a mob. The local mob thus initially vandalized the premises of the office of the Konyak Union (KU), from where the funeral procession was to start. Thereafter, the crowd started moving towards the main gate of the Bn Tac HQ, Mon, of 27 AR. They initially set the main gate on fire and

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